

iQOO 13

Most powerful phone under ₹60,000?

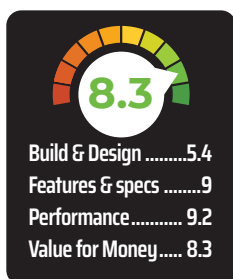
iQOO as a brand is known for its heavy-performance smartphones that come to the market at a very justified price. I still remember, the iQOO 11 launched as India's fastest smartphone because it was the first smartphone in India with the Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 processor. Now, 2 years later, we have the iQOO 13 that is powered by the Snapdragon 8 Elite processor, a processor that can even beat laptops when it comes to performance.

However, iQOO has been focusing beyond performance for the last two years. For example, the iQOO 12 had quite an impressive camera. Now, with the iQOO 13, what are you getting? More importantly, whatever you are getting, how well is it working? That's why you and I, both are here to find out whether the iQOO 13 is worth the price or not. So, let's begin!

PERFORMANCE

It's a performance-centric smartphone, so let's start with its performance. Now, we all know that the Snapdragon 8 Elite is a powerful chipset. But there is one major factor that matters a lot – "how stable is the processor inside a smartphone?" There are many optimisations included while powering a smartphone with a processor, if you don't do that right, the processor will not deliver the power properly.

To start with, I ran the AnTuTu benchmark test on the iQOO 13 to test how powerful the Snapdragon 8 Elite is. According to this benchmark, AnTuTu showed that the chip scored around 2.7 million, which is quite similar to what the Realme GT 7 Pro has achieved. For more context, the Realme GT 7 Pro is the true competitor of the iQOO 13. But, if we look at the numbers more closely, the iQOO 13 was slightly more powerful than the Realme GT 7 Pro.



The GT 7 Pro scored 2736448 on AnTuTu, and on the other hand, the iQOO 13 scored 2764967. Now this isn't a very big difference but still, the numbers are in front of you.

Next, I ran the Geekbench benchmark, where the iQOO 13 scored slightly better than the Realme GT 7 Pro. Geekbench evaluates processor performance for daily tasks such as calls, social media, and videos, as well as heavy tasks like gaming and editing.

Now, coming to the main test: CPU throttling. This revealed something very interesting about the iQOO 13. If you put it under moderate load, it won't reach its peak performance. But if you push it to the extreme like opening 30-40 apps simultaneously, that's when it truly shows its power. However, it does heat up significantly under such aggressive loads. But that's okay because if it doesn't heat up at all, that would be a concern. Besides, it cools down within just 20-25 minutes.

After running CPU Throttling, one thing I know for sure is that the iQOO

13 is a heavy-performance smartphone. I ran three 30 minutes of these tests on 40 threads, that's also why it heated up, but apart from that, the iQOO 13 was as smooth as ice.

That said, most of you might never push it to such limits. At most, you would probably engage in some high-graphics gaming. So, I fired up a BGMI match as well. There was no lag, no glitch, no frame drop, nothing. The game ran very smoothly on high-graphics settings, and the phone didn't even heat up much.

Along with good performance, we need other things also on a smartphone, right? Like the camera, which iQOO has focused on a lot this year as well.

CAMERA

The iQOO 13 is equipped with a triple camera setup, consisting of a 50-megapixel Sony IMX921 main camera, a 50-megapixel Sony telephoto lens with 2x optical zoom, and a 50-megapixel ISOCELL JN1 ultrawide lens. Now, the catch here is that iQOO has removed the 64-megapixel periscope telephoto sensor that had up to 3x optical zoom from the iQOO 13. The iQOO 12's camera did rounds and the major reason behind it is its periscope telephoto sensor.

Would you call this a downgrade? Wait, till you see iQOO 13's camera samples.

I think iQOO 13's camera is not as good as its predecessor. Starting with the portraits, as you can see the edge detection on these pictures is just satisfactory. For example, in the cycle rickshaw picture, the main subject is out of focus, while the areas that should be blurred remain in focus.

After this, light management is one thing this smartphone struggles with. It's quite visible in low-light photos like these pictures with lit up buildings where you can see light bleeding, and the sky looks very hazy in every picture. In daylight also, you can see a proper halo behind my head.

Apart from this, the wide-angle camera isn't that great, and in low light, its performance drops even more.

But despite all this, after the iQOO 12, the iQOO 13 is the second-best camera phone from this brand. Because even